

The Mind of the Closer

Simplified Version

Close with Power, Clarity, and Integrity

Based on the Nova Structa sales consultation flow.

Purpose

This guide simplifies the original playbook into a clear step-by-step process. The goal is to help a representative lead a professional solar consultation, build trust, explain the program clearly, answer concerns, and help the homeowner decide if the program is a good fit.

Core Rules

- Lead with confidence and warmth.
- Keep the conversation organized from start to finish.
- Use only accurate facts, prices, incentives, and timelines.
- Listen carefully. Do not rush past concerns.
- If the program is not a fit, be honest and say so.
- No pressure. Clear information creates better decisions.

The 8 C Framework

1. Control the Conversation

Start with a calm, confident tone. Set the pace and explain what will happen. If the homeowner jumps ahead, acknowledge the question and bring the conversation back to the process.

Example: "Great question. I will write that down and come back to it once I lay everything out."

2. Connect with Intent

Build quick trust by being human. Greet everyone, notice the home, make light conversation, and help the homeowner feel comfortable.

3. Clarify the Frame

Explain the consultation in three simple steps: review energy use, explain the program, and run the savings report. Make it clear that if the numbers do not make sense, there is no pressure to move forward.

4. Collect Credibility

Use short, verified facts to show that solar is common and practical. Mention local laws, communities, companies, or examples only when you know they are accurate.

5. Create Urgency

Help the homeowner understand the cost of doing nothing. Use their current bill and real numbers. The point is not to scare them; it is to show why comparing options matters.

6. Craft the Solution

Explain solar as a simpler, more predictable alternative if the homeowner qualifies. Avoid jargon. Focus on the result: lower cost, more control, and a clear process.

7. Cultivate Objections

Ask for every question or concern before answering. Write them down. Go one by one, ask follow-up questions, answer clearly, and confirm each concern is resolved before moving on.

Example: "Got it. What else?" / "When you say that, can you tell me more?"

8. Command the Close

After the homeowner understands the program, connect the decision to their main reason for considering solar: savings, home value, or the environment. Ask for a clear next step if the numbers work.

Simple Consultation Flow

Step 1: Build the Relationship

- Greet the homeowner naturally.
- Ask if you should remove your shoes.
- Acknowledge spouse, kids, pets, or anyone else present.
- Use a light compliment or friendly observation to make the room comfortable.

Example: "Hey, you must be [Name]. Should I take my shoes off, or are we good?"

Step 2: Explain the Process

Set expectations before collecting information.

Example: "Here is what we are doing. First, I will check your energy use and take a few photos of the meter and breaker. Then I will explain the program and answer your questions. After that, we will run the savings report. If it comes out lower than your current bill and makes sense, great. If not, no problem."

Confirm: "You want to pay less for electricity, right?"

Step 3: Site Survey and Rapport

Take the needed photos and keep the conversation friendly. If a main panel upgrade may be needed, explain it simply and accurately.

Example: "If your home qualifies and the electrical box needs to be upgraded, one possible benefit is that the upgrade may be included at no extra upfront cost. Is that okay with you?"

Step 4: Build Credibility

Share a few quick facts that are relevant to the homeowner. Keep this short. Then ask why they think cities, builders, or companies are switching to solar.

Example: "Why do you think more homes and companies are switching to solar?"

Step 5: Explain the Problem

Use the homeowner's current bill to explain why utility costs matter. Avoid exaggeration. Use verified rate information only.

Example: "Right now, you are paying the utility every month with no fixed end date and no ownership. If there is an option that is lower and more predictable, it is worth checking."

Step 6: Present the Solution

Explain that the application determines whether they qualify. If they do qualify, the goal is to replace an unpredictable utility bill with a clearer, more predictable solar payment, subject to program terms.

Example: "The program is simple. If you qualify, we look for a lower and more predictable option. We help schedule the site visit, handle the design and paperwork, and coordinate the utility steps."

Step 7: Reinforce Trust

Make the homeowner feel safe asking questions. Your priority is that they understand the program and feel comfortable with the decision.

Example: "My priority is that you are comfortable, understand everything, and only move forward if it makes sense for your home."

Step 8: Discovery

Ask for all questions and concerns. Do not answer only the first one and move on. Keep asking until they say there are no more.

Ask: "What questions or concerns do you have?"

Then: "Got it. What else?"

For each concern: "Can you tell me more about that?"

After answering: "Is that still a concern, or is everything clear now?"

Step 9: Transition to the Close

Once concerns are handled, help the homeowner identify their main motivation.

Ask: "If you had to pick one reason to go solar, would it be saving money, building home value, or helping the environment?"

Closing Paths

Path A: Savings

If the homeowner cares most about saving money, focus on their current bill, future increases, and monthly predictability.

Questions: "How long have you been paying that much?" "What is the highest bill you have seen?" "If nothing changes, where could your bill be in a few years?"

Close: "If the numbers come back lower and more predictable, would you feel comfortable moving forward?"

Path B: Home Value / Ownership

If they care about equity or value, compare renting power from the utility with owning more control over their energy.

Questions: "Why did you buy instead of rent?" "How does it feel to pay the utility every month with no return?"

Close: "If your home qualifies, would locking in ownership of your power make sense?"

Path C: Environment

If they care about the environment, focus on producing cleaner energy at home and reducing dependence on traditional power sources.

Questions: "Do you know where your power comes from now?" "How would it feel to produce cleaner power from your own home?"

Close: "If your house qualifies, would moving forward with cleaner energy feel like the right decision?"

After Qualification

Contract Walkthrough

If the homeowner qualifies and chooses to move forward, guide them calmly through the documents. Explain DocuSign in simple terms and let them review at their own pace.

Example: "You should have received the documents by email. DocuSign is simple. You can review the pages and tap the yellow boxes where signatures are needed."

Stay quiet and patient while they review. If they hesitate, stop the signing process and ask what is still on their mind.

Example: "Let's pause for a second. I want to make sure you are 100% comfortable. Is there anything still on your mind?"

Next Steps

- Schedule the site survey.
- Engineering reviews photos, measurements, and videos.
- The design is submitted for permit approval.
- After permit approval, installation is scheduled.
- The system is inspected.
- The utility completes the meter swap or final activation steps.
- The system turns on after approvals are complete.

Typical timing can vary based on the city, permit office, utility, and project details. Do not promise a timeline unless it has been confirmed.

Final Items to Collect

- Utility login access, if needed for the meter swap process.
- Homeowner insurance declaration page if required for larger systems.
- A final customer photo only if the homeowner is comfortable.

Optional Model Home Close

If the company offers a model home discount or sign program, explain it clearly and only after confirming the home may qualify.

Example: "If we are able to place a small sign in your yard for a few months, I may be able to request a better price. I would need manager approval first. Would you be comfortable with that if it helps lower the cost?"

If Credit Is Denied

1. Check the Lender Email

Have the homeowner open the lender email to see the reason for denial.

2. If Credit Is Frozen or Blocked

- Explain that many people freeze credit for security.
- Help them identify which bureau or site must be unlocked.
- After they unlock it, resubmit only with their permission.

3. If Credit Score Is Too Low

- Ask if they would like to try with a qualified co-applicant.
- Only use another person's information with clear consent.
- If there is no second path, suggest improving credit and following up later.

Example: "This does not have to be the end. If your credit improves a little, we can come back and try again."

Quick Checklist

- Open warmly.
- Set the three-step frame.
- Collect site information.
- Share short, accurate credibility points.
- Explain the cost of staying with the utility.
- Present the program simply.
- Ask for every concern.
- Resolve concerns one by one.
- Find the main reason: savings, home value, or environment.
- Ask for the next step if the numbers make sense.
- If they hesitate, pause and return to discovery.

Simple Closing Principle

A strong close is not about pressure. It is about leadership, clarity, trust, and timing.

Help the homeowner understand the facts, connect the program to what matters to them, and make a confident decision.